

# AI for Recruitment

Structured, fair interviews — not gut-feeling conversations

## What You Will Learn

- Generate a balanced mix of technical and behavioral interview questions.
- Understand why a structured interview with a shared rubric beats free-form conversation.
- Build and apply a simple scoring rubric to real candidate answers.
- Identify and fix an interview question that could be unfair or irrelevant.

## 1. From Job Description to Interview Questions

Once a job description exists, AI can quickly generate a first set of interview questions from it — a mix of technical questions (testing a specific skill) and behavioral questions (testing how someone has actually handled real situations in the past).

### *Example — technical vs behavioral*

*Technical: "How would you clean a dataset with duplicate customer records?" Behavioral: "Tell me about a time you had to fix a mistake you made at work — what did you do?" Both are useful; they test different things.*

## 2. Structured Interviews Beat Gut Feeling

Asking every candidate the same set of questions, scored against the same rubric, produces fairer and more comparable results than a free-flowing conversation that changes from candidate to candidate. AI is useful here for drafting both the fixed question set and a scoring rubric — consistency is the whole point.

## 3. Evaluating Candidates Without Over-Trusting AI Scoring

AI can suggest a scoring rubric (what a 5-out-of-5 answer looks like vs a 1-out-of-5 answer). It cannot actually judge a real candidate's real answer with full context — tone, follow-up clarification, specific situational nuance. The rubric is a tool for a human interviewer to apply consistently, not a replacement for the human's judgment on the actual answer given.

### ACTIVITY 1: Generate and Prioritize Interview Questions

**Step 1.** Take a job description (your own, or from Chapter 27's activity).

**Step 2.** Ask AI for 5 interview questions — a mix of technical and behavioral.

**Step 3.** Pick the 3 you'd actually ask first, and explain why those 3 matter most for this specific role.

**Worked example:** Role: Marketing Intern. AI suggests 5 questions covering social media tools, a past teamwork example, creativity, deadline pressure, and a hypothetical campaign idea. Priority pick: the teamwork example and the hypothetical campaign idea reveal the most about real fit for an intern role, ahead of a tool-specific question that can be trained on the job.

## ACTIVITY 2: Build and Apply a Scoring Rubric

**Step 1.** Pick one interview question.

**Step 2.** Ask AI to build a 1-5 scoring rubric for it (what a 5 looks like vs a 1).

**Step 3.** Write two sample candidate answers yourself, then score both using the rubric.

**Worked example:** Question: "Tell me about a time you handled a difficult customer." Rubric 5: specific situation, clear action taken, positive resolution described. Rubric 1: vague, no specific example, no resolution mentioned. Sample Answer A (specific, resolved issue) scores a 4-5; Sample Answer B ("I'm usually good with people", no example) scores a 1-2 under the same rubric.

## ACTIVITY 3: Spot and Fix a Problematic Question

**Step 1.** Review the 5 AI-generated questions from Activity 1.

**Step 2.** Identify one that could unintentionally be discriminatory, irrelevant, or unfair to certain candidates.

**Step 3.** Rewrite it into a fairer, more job-relevant version.

**Worked example:** Original AI question: "Do you have any commitments outside work that might affect your availability?" — this can indirectly probe for caregiving responsibilities, which is inappropriate. Rewritten: "This role sometimes requires weekend event coverage — is that something you're able to commit to?" (asks about the actual job requirement, not personal life).